



August 13, 2026

NICOLAS HERNANDEZ

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] CA 9[REDACTED]

Patient: Nicolas Hernandez

DMHC#: [REDACTED]23

Health Plan: Local Initiative Health Authority for L.A. County (L.A. Care Health Plan)

Dear Nicolas Hernandez:

Thank you for sending your Independent Medical Review (IMR)/Complaint Form to the Department of Managed Health Care (Department).

You are receiving this letter because additional information is required to process your request. Please refer to the "Requested Information Sheet" on Page 3 of this letter for the specific information needed.

Please submit the requested information along with the Requested Information Sheet (Page 3 of this letter) to the Department no later than August 20, 2026. Please note you must include the Requested Information Sheet (Page 3) to ensure the information you submit is attached to your case.

The quickest way to return this information to the Department is by sending it via email to helpline@dmhc.ca.gov or by fax to 916-255-5241. If either of those two options are not available to you, the requested information can be mailed to:

**Department of Managed Health Care
Help Center
980 9th Street Suite 500
Sacramento CA 95814**

If you are unable to respond with the requested information by August 20, 2026, your complaint will be closed. You may use the enclosed IMR Application/Complaint Form to request that a new case be opened. You may also file an online IMR Application/Complaint Form at www.DMHC.ca.gov.

Gavin Newsom, Governor
State of California
Health and Human Services Agency
DEPARTMENT OF MANAGED HEALTH CARE
980 9th Street, Suite 500
Sacramento, CA 95814
Toll-Free: 1-888-466-2219 | Fax: 916-255-5241
Email: helpline@dmhc.ca.gov
www.DMHC.ca.gov

Sincerely,

M.B.

Standard Complaint Branch
Help Center
Department of Managed Health Care

Attachment(s)

REQUESTED INFORMATION SHEET

- ☐ Please complete all sections of the enclosed IMR/Complaint Form.
- ☐ Please complete and sign the Medical Release section on the enclosed IMR/Complaint Form.

Note: An enrollee 18 years of age or older must sign the IMR/Complaint Form unless legal documentation is provided showing that someone else has the authority to act on the enrollee's behalf.

- ☐ Please complete the highlighted section(s) of the enclosed Authorized Assistant Form. If we do not receive a completed Authorized Assistant form, we can still process your IMR/Complaint. However, we will only be able to share information about the IMR/Complaint with you.
- ☐ Please provide the specific medical treatment(s)/service(s), and/or medication(s) you are requesting. Please see the highlighted section of the enclosed IMR/Complaint Form.
- ☐ Please provide a letter signed by your physician/provider certifying that an imminent and serious threat to your health exists and your case should be expedited. Please note that the letter must describe the imminent and serious threat that exists.
- ☐ Please complete and return the enclosed Legal Representative for Deceased Patient Form, along with copies of applicable documentation (i.e., death certificate and either a will, trust, or a court order demonstrating you are the legal representative for the deceased patient).
- ☒ Please provide the clarification:

Your health plan states they have made multiple outreach attempts, mailed an unable to contact letter, and opened a Case Management episode, but have been unable to reach you at [REDACTED] due to a full voicemail mailbox and lack of response. As a result, the provider cannot complete a risk assessment or implement a stabilization plan.

1. Can you please confirm if you are still requesting the department's assistance?
2. Please contact your health plan so they may assist you with setting up an appointment.

Yes. Please see attached signed Response to Requested Clarification.

RESPONSE TO REQUESTED CLARIFICATION

DMHC Case # [REDACTED] 23

Patient: Nicolas Hernandez

Health Plan: L.A. Care Health Plan

To the Department of Managed Health Care:

I am responding to the Requested Information Sheet dated August 13, 2026.

Yes, I am still requesting the Department's review of my complaint.

On August 13, 2026, I attended the referred appointment at Bartz Altadonna Community Health Center. During that appointment, a physician agreed to assume management of my established benzodiazepine taper. A prescription for diazepam was issued, and a follow-up appointment was scheduled.

As a result, I am no longer requesting immediate assistance locating a clinician to manage the taper, because that specific treatment need has now been addressed.

However, I am still requesting that the Department review the delays and access-to-care issues that occurred before treatment was finally established, including the period during which I did not have an accepting clinician managing the taper.

I also wish to clarify that I do not agree with any characterization that I failed to respond to outreach without context. I had multiple communications regarding my care and appointment arrangements. I can provide supporting call records, messages, or other documentation if the Department requires them.

Please update **DMHC Case # [REDACTED] 23** to reflect that the immediate treatment-access issue was resolved on August 13, 2026, while my request for review of the preceding access-to-care issues remains active.

Sincerely,

Nicolas Hernandez

Signature: [REDACTED]

Date: 08/14/2026